STEADFAST MEN

Lesson 17 · Destiny Is Not a Vibe

Transcript · Wes Hart

Hey. Good to see you sitting down. If you came in quiet, that's fine. Uh, a man on the aisle tried his chair, didn't trust it, and tried the next one. He sat. Then he eyed the chair like it had turned him in. I've been that man. Glad you stayed in yours. If this voice is new, I'm Wes. You've got the name. Last time we named what was given before anything in a man broke. Design first. Then the fork. Some of you said your piece plain. Some of you, uh, carried it out and left it in a pocket. Today I'm not walking that ground again. I want the work the ground was for. Now listen. Ask a man what— ask a man what he is for. Watch his eyes, uh, hunt a window. He knows the hours. He knows, uh, the route. Ask him why the route matters, and the answer gets thin. I mean, he is not lost on the schedule. He is, uh, busy. Busy is not a why. I have stacked whole days and still couldn't name the person they were for. Here's the thing. Plenty of us, uh, hunt a feeling and call that feeling destiny. A warmth in the chest. A click that says, this one counts. The click fades. We decide the work faded with it. Destiny is not a vibe. It is serving God's purpose in your own generation, in the place he put you, for the people he gave you, until it is finished. How many of you are still waiting on a feeling before you'll treat today as the work? Hand up. Nobody is collecting them. Yeah. Mine, uh, stayed down a long time. The life still matched the hands that went up. Stay with me. We're gonna name what the wait has been for. Then what God already put in reach.

One sentence hands us four marks. I have not improved them. A steadfast man stops waiting, picks up the weight, goes first, and works for God's pay, not the room's. You've heard them in this room. I'm not opening all four from the floor. Uh, today they stay where they belong. Over the work. Not in place of it. Feeling is not the fire. Say that where you can hear it. A man can recite the marks and still wait for his chest to approve the day. I have done that with a calm voice and, uh, a full calendar. I called the wait, uh, wisdom. It was passivity wearing a clean shirt. The marks tell a man how to walk. They do not hand him a mood. You can say stop waiting and still be waiting on a feeling. That wait is the passivity. You can talk about the weight and never touch the person already standing in front of you. I'm not gonna walk all four again. What I want in your ear is the sentence they stand over. A purpose from God. Your own generation. A real place. People with names. A finish. If the only proof you trust can fade before supper, you will chase the proof and call the chase a life. So let me set the sentence down bare. Destiny is not a vibe. It is serving God's purpose in your own generation, in the place he put you, for the people he gave you, until it is finished. I have— I have let a feeling drive, and called the ride discernment. Uh, it was delay. Delay with a softer name. It kept me seated. Seated can feel like patience. It isn't. The softer name did not do the work.

Acts thirteen, verse thirty-six. The story reaches a king named David. Here is the line. Now when David had served God's purpose in his own generation, he fell asleep. He was buried with his ancestors, and his body decayed. Stay with the verbs. Served. Not stumbled onto. Not felt his way toward. Served God's purpose. The purpose was God's. Uh, a man can have plenty of wants. David did. The wants that start in us do not automatically bless the people in our care. The purpose this verse keeps is the one that came from God. In his own generation. Not the crowd behind him. Not a better century he wished he'd been handed. The people alive while he was alive. Think about, uh, how small that circle feels when you say it at your own table. A kid. A wife, if she's there. The men who already know your voice. That is a generation. Not a crowd you have not met. Then the sentence ends him. He fell asleep. Buried. The body decayed. Uh, that ending is doing work. If the point had been David staying famous, the line could have stopped earlier. It doesn't. He served. Then he was done. What mattered kept going without his body in the room. You are not asked to become a monument. You are asked to serve while your people are still here. You don't, you know, have to be the man they name later. You have to be the man who served while they could see you. The verse does not, uh, check his mood. It checks his service. It names his generation. It tells you he came to an end. You can obey that on a day that feels like errands, with no click in your chest at all.

Here is a lie that steers quiet men. You'll know the work when you feel it. Somewhere ahead, uh, sits a life that finally feels right, and the discomfort is proof you haven't found it yet. I told my wife I was seeking clarity. What I found was the trash. Same kitchen. Different hour. I have— I have stood at the sink with a plate that was already clean, still rubbing it, because I did not feel like a man with anything worth saying. My boy was in the doorway with a question about a teacher. I said, give me a minute. Uh, the minute was a feeling. The feeling did not come. He, uh, went down the hall. I still remember the plate clearer than the question. That's the lie with soap on its hands. A feeling may tell you you're tired, or sore, or glad the day ended. It is a poor boss. I mean, it will change its mind before the work is done, and then blame you for a job it never assigned. I have held an apology until I felt humble enough to walk it over. Humble never knocked. Uh, the apology was the humble thing. I kept waiting, and my wife got silence with a spiritual name on it. Some of you won't pray out loud with a kid in the room until your voice feels steady. The kid is not waiting on a performance. He's waiting on you. Go do the thing. A calm chest might show up after. It might stay noisy. The work does not grade you on that. If you have been parked until the inside agrees, that park has a name. It's a destiny lie. Name it while you're still in the chair. The chest is not the one who assigns.

Another lie says the real one is large. A life people retell. A name that travels past your street. So a man, uh, looks at faithful years and files them under keeping things running. I hunted a sense of significance for a whole Saturday. One of my kids needed cleats. I checked the garage. I checked the hall. The cleats were under my seat. I had walked past the work looking for a better story. Uh, I kept— I kept calling it maintenance, the long stretch where I just showed up.

Showed up for the kids. Showed up for the job in front of me. Showed up for a man who was sinking and needed a ride so he could tell the truth. None of it looked like a tale anybody would repeat. I wanted, uh, the tale. The people did not need my tale. They needed a man in the car. Luke sixteen, verse ten. Whoever can be trusted with very little can also be trusted with much, and whoever is dishonest with very little will also be dishonest with much. Hear the measure. Very little. A lunch you pack and nobody posts. A ride across town that never becomes a story. A budget you hold so the house doesn't shake. God is not waiting for a crowd, uh, to agree that those counted. A man who shrugs at the little will fumble a louder day too, because his hands already learned to despise what they were given. Big things, you know, do happen. Sometimes. The lie is that the plain day is just the lobby where you wait for the real room. If your days look ordinary, you may be in the work, not beside it. Don't file a generation under maintenance.

Another lie moves the address. The real purpose is somewhere else. After a wedding. After the kids, uh, are up and gone. After the job lets go of you. In a town you have not walked. The door keeps shifting. Uh, you stay in the hall of your own actual life. I have refreshed a route on my phone while the car sat in park in my own driveway. A place I'd never stood. Uh, pretty pictures. I called it vision. My wife asked if vision was gonna fix the hinge that had cried for months. I said life would settle, and then I'd get to the hinge. The hinge was the assignment. The real life was— the real life was always one picture past the one I was in. I fixed the hinge that night. No speech. The door shut clean. I did not feel like a man on a mission. I felt like a man with a screwdriver. That was the step. I had labeled it later. Proverbs sixteen, verse nine. In their hearts humans plan their course, but the Lord establishes their steps. You can plan a fine course all afternoon. God is already in the step under your shoes. Uh, that does not mean you never move. If he moves you, it will be more than a restless night and a picture on a screen. Until then, this town is not a hallway you endure on the way to living. This job is not a holding pen. This house is not a rehearsal set. I mean, a man can spend his good years getting ready to arrive at an address he does not have. You've felt that pull, right? The noble reason to be anywhere but here. Here already has names. Write those before you write the someday town.

So the feeling can lie. The size, uh, can lie. The elsewhere can lie. What is left. An assignment. Ephesians two, verse ten. For we are God's handiwork, created in Christ Jesus to do good works, which God prepared in advance for us to do. Prepared in advance. You are not out digging for a hidden biography. You are not one mood away from becoming the real version. The works were laid down before you walked into the day. That frees you from the fear of the wrong trail. Uh, if there's one secret purpose and you might miss it forever, every ordinary yes feels like a trap. If the work was prepared, you can do the thing already sitting in your hands. You don't— you don't find it by tearing through a neighbor's garage for a key that's in your pocket. Second Corinthians five, verse fifteen. And he died for all, that those who live should no longer live for themselves but for him who died for them and was raised again. There's the aim inside the work. Not for yourself. For him. A purpose that never costs you for somebody else is still about

you. You just gave it church words. The people are how it looks before supper. Her name, if a wife is yours. The kids' names, if kids are yours. Uh, the man on your shift who already knows your face. The church row that would notice if your chair stayed empty. You were not handed a private legend. You were handed people. Your purpose has an address. It is local on purpose. If you can't say the names, you are still, uh, hunting a legend. A legend has no address. Say the names before you leave the chair.

A mood will not finish a thing. Remember that when the click is gone and the work is only half done. Colossians four, verse seventeen. See to it that you complete the ministry you have received in the Lord. Complete. Not feel lit up by it. Not announce it. Complete it. Uh, I know the half-done pile. Good words I meant to say and, uh, left sitting in my mouth. A promise to one of my kids I kept loose, ready if I felt generous, easy to drop if I didn't. That is not a finish. That is a man keeping an exit. Some of us start ten good things and bring none of them to the end, and we call the pile potential. I mean, potential is not the ministry you were handed. Complete means the younger man heard the whole truth, not just the warm intro. Complete means the kid got the conversation, not another rain check. Complete means the job in front of you got to the last honest page, not the page where you got bored. A finish can look dull. Uh, the same lunch made again. The same hard talk you don't dodge. The same man you keep meeting until the truth has a chair. It will not get framed. It still closes a real work. Faithfulness is what finishes. Heat visits. Heat leaves. Faithfulness clocks back in. You can feel flat and still bring a thing to an end. I have felt flat and quit. I have felt flat and stayed. Only one of those left something done for somebody else. When it's over, God is the one still looking. He will not ask what the day felt like. Inspired fades by morning. Finished is still finished. He will know what you finished.

So how do you see the work without hunting a secret. You write a card. Not a speech, uh, for the mirror. Not a poster for the wall. One card. Five lines. I wrote the word impact on a card once. Impact did not have a phone number. Yours needs names. The card is— the card is five clues you can actually touch. Place. The town, uh, you're standing in. The work you already do. The street. The church that has your face. If God moves you later, he moves you. Until then, this ground is yours to work. People. Names, not roles. If there's a wife, her name. Not the word family. Kids by their names. The man you would skip if the day got tight. Uh, those names are the generation. Hands. What you can actually do with the hands you've got. Not the gift you wish was louder. Maybe you fix what's broken. Maybe you stay calm when a room starts to tilt. Maybe you can sit with a man and not flinch when he tells the truth. Use that. This stretch. The season you are actually in. Not the chapter you're rewriting into something easier to admire. A house with a baby in it. A place of your own and no one in it. A tired heart and two front doors. Uh, quiet mornings. A good run at the job. Serve this one. Don't sand it into a better life first. And the first shape. Last time we named the design, what a man was given before anything broke. You don't need me to rebuild it. Put one line of it on the card, the part you keep leaving

off. One line under each clue. Then one of those lines has to leave the card and become a thing you did. If the card stays pretty and nothing in your hands moves, you kept a feeling and skipped the service.

Let me tell you about a man. I'll call him Reed. He sat in rooms like this and got quiet when purpose came up. He'd say he was between things. He wasn't. He had a wife, a shift he was good at, and a son who built shelves that leaned. By Reed's back door, on a nail, hung a cap from a town he had driven through once. Uh, not his town. The town he had decided was the real one. Uh, he would— he would take the cap down when he talked about getting there, and rub the brim like it might warm up. I stopped by his place one afternoon. The boy, uh, came out with sawdust on his socks, holding a shelf that leaned like it had an opinion. He said, Dad, come look before it gets stuck in the garage. Reed had the cap in his hand. He said, hang on, my head's somewhere else. The somewhere else was the cap. The boy set the shelf against the wall, careful, like it might still get seen. It didn't. Reed hung the cap back on the nail. A good while later we were putting chairs up in a room like this. He said it quiet. I keep thinking the real work is in that town. My kid stopped bringing me the crooked stuff. I told him the town on the cap had never asked him for a thing. His boy had. The brim did not need another rub. The boy needed a dad in the yard. Reed didn't move towns. He asked his son to show him the next crooked thing on purpose. They fixed, uh, a gate that was never gonna be a story. A friend of the boy started coming by, uh, because a dad was actually home. Reed told me later it still doesn't feel like a calling. The yard is full anyway. The generation had been hanging on a nail by his own back door.

Let me walk the room as it actually is. If you're young, stop waiting for a perfect map. The next faithful turn is the work. Uh, a full route that finally feels exciting is just a polished way to stay parked. Open the road you already have. Take the turn. If you're single, a future wife is not the assignment. I'll call him Shane. Good man. He told me his purpose would switch on when he had a wife. Meanwhile his nephew kept asking him to show up at a game, and a younger guy at work had asked him how to pray. Shane said he'd get to both when his life started. A wife is— a wife is a gift when God gives one. She is not the ignition. The nephew already has a name. If you're married, put names on the card. Not a vibe. Her name first. If you write the family and can't say who you mean, you wrote a fog. If the house has a baby in it, that child is not a pause in your purpose. That child is on the card. If the marriage came apart, the purpose did not close with it. The next faithful thing still has somebody's name on it. If you're hurt, hear this slow. The worst thing done to you is real. It is not a job title. God can bring good through a wound. The wound does not get to name the purpose. A scar is a record. It is not a commission. Build the whole life around what broke you, and you will call the break a calling. You will miss the people still standing in front of you. If you've been at this a long time, your generation is not behind you. It's the men, you know, still in reach of your voice. A name in your phone you only scroll past, uh, that name is unfinished work. And if the job is going well, be glad. An early close is a skill. It is

not a destiny. You can shut the day down, feel complete, and still hand the people at home whatever energy is left. When the close starts pretending it was the purpose, you've swapped a skill for a calling.

Let me say the whole thing plain, and then the tables are yours. Destiny is not a vibe. It is serving God's purpose in your own generation, in the place he put you, for the people he gave you, until it is finished. I hope you walk out of here done hunting a feeling and able to say, with real names, what God's purpose looks like where you already live. Your workbook has the lines for it. In a minute you'll sit down together and work this part. So put these questions in your mouth the way you're gonna ask them. Which destiny lie have you been living under? The one that says you'll feel it when it's real. The one that says it has to be large. Or the one that keeps moving the address. Say which one. Out loud. Today. In one sentence, with names in it, what does God's purpose in your own generation look like? Names. Not a mood you hope shows up. What is one line from the five-clue card you will do? Place. People. Hands. This stretch. The first shape. One line. Then do that thing. And what have you been waiting to feel, and for how long? Tell a brother. Read him the card. Ask him what he sees God's purpose looking like in your life right now. Uh, if all you give him is that you want more purpose, he can nod, and you leave still hunting a click. How many of you already know the lie and want the sentence kept soft? Hand up. I'm not writing it down. Alright. Don't drop it walking to the table. You've carried the marks through this room. A steadfast man stops waiting, picks up the weight, goes first, and works for God's pay, not the room's. What I hope— what I hope you carry is a purpose you can serve with no vibe attached to it. Do what's already in your hands. Do it where he put you. Do it for the people he gave you. See it through. Tables. Work that part of the workbook together. Start with the lie. Say it plain.